

Segment 4 - Rumely Rd to Peter White Rd

(Former Segment 4 has been split into Segments 4 & 5) February 2025 [Google Map of Segment 4](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopter: Eastern portion-: Lynn Meister-Thomas & Chuck Thomas, (906) 280-2835, lmeister906@gmail.com,
Western portion: Alicia Beauchamp, abeauchamp@gmail.com, (906) 360-4263

Segment length: About 3.5 miles, east to west 328 ft of ascent, 304 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) : Use Map # 48 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Brad Slagle 906 236-2776) with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

This beautiful and somewhat challenging section features waterfalls, two creek crossings and the Laughing Whitefish River (bridge crossing).

From your vehicle at (46.391475,-87.032603) following the blue blazes, head west on the road from the Rumely Rd parking area for about a ¼ mile. Just after the road ends, listen up and you will hear water falls flowing below your feet and directly out of the canyon wall on your right. Immediately after that you will cross a small creek just above Pipe Falls. After 2 miles, steps will take you down to the Laughing Whitefish River. Use caution on the approaches to the bridge; they are in bad condition. Steps then take you up the other side. Shortly after reaching the top, you will come to the intersection of the spur to the Laughing Whitefish Falls, another worthwhile side trip. From there you will cross an unnamed logging road and then come to the West Branch of the Laughing Whitefish River, where you will likely need to rock hop to get across. The final .25 mile takes you to the end of the segment at Peter White Rd (46.413762,-87.067921).

Driving Directions:

Eastern Trailhead

From M-94 west of Eben Junction, head north on [*Rumely Rd.*]/County Highway 339] for approximately 3 miles. Park at the Y in the road. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving map from M94 to Rumely Rd parking for Segments 3 & 4](#)

Western Trailhead

The roads to reach the western trailhead are very rough, sometimes flooded and seasonably impassable and should not be attempted with anything other than a high clearance 4WD vehicle. It is recommended that this segment be combined with Segments 5 & 6. Contact Brad Slagle (above) with any questions.

Camping:

This segment is mostly commercial forest land and State of Michigan property, so dispersed camping is available.

Water Access:

Water is available at Pipe Falls, the Laughing Whitefish River and the West Branch of the Laughing Whitefish River.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter, the eastern trailhead should be reachable by any vehicle. In the winter, you can take Rumely Rd until the plowing ends, and then hike the roughly .5 mile to the beginning of the segment. The western trailhead can only be reached via a high clearance 4WD from late spring through early winter. It is not reachable via vehicle during the wintertime.